



Empowering Azerbaijani SME Consultants

Hands-On AI & Digitalization Training
Program for EBRD Advice for Small Businesses

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Our Mission

At Flowlyst, our mission is to revolutionize business offices by enhancing operational efficiency through innovative automation solutions. We are committed to liberating valuable time for your team by streamlining and automating business office workflows. By developing adaptable data structures, we enable deeper analysis and foster data-driven decision-making, making complex tasks like forecasting and risk assessment more accessible and efficient.

Our vision is to empower leaders, including Business Managers, Chief Financial Officers, Superintendents, Operations Managers, and other Administrators with the tools they need to excel. We provide cutting-edge automation technologies that simplify processes, enhance productivity, and allow leaders to focus on strategic goals rather than routine tasks. This empowerment leads to more dynamic and effective management across organizations.

We are dedicated to building lasting relationships with our clients, whom we consider part of our extended family. Our commitment to enhancing your team's productivity is unwavering, and we strive to achieve complete satisfaction in every project. Partnering with Flowlyst means investing in a future where your organizational needs are met with precision and your operations run smoother than ever. We ensure that working with us is a decision that brings lasting benefits and success.





Our Services

Automation consulting

Our automation services encompass a wide range of solutions including the development of structured budgeting systems, data visualization techniques, multi-year salary projection, enrollment projection, risk assessment models, financial projections, and the automation of Excel and Google Sheet worksheets for internal operations, among others. Our approach to budget automation simplifies the sharing and collaboration of spreadsheets across different departments within your organization, district, or city. This methodology not only facilitates the easy collection and contribution of data by allowing controlled access but also ensures the integrity of your meticulously crafted formulas. With a central, dynamic summary sheet, you'll witness real-time updates as various departments submit their inputs. This streamlined process is designed to significantly reduce both time and stress, empowering you with critical insights. We invite you to inquire about our past projects to see how we can tailor our expertise to your needs.

Training packages

Dive into the rapidly evolving world of artificial intelligence with our **hands-on AI and Digitalization Training**, specifically tailored for business consultants supporting small and medium-sized enterprises. As AI reshapes business research, analysis, and client deliverables across every sector, mastering its potential has become essential for forward-thinking consultants.

Our program demystifies the fundamentals of generative AI and explores its real-world applications in the context of SME consulting. From automating complex reporting tasks and streamlining business diagnostics to enhancing market research, project management, and client communications, participants will learn to leverage AI tools for building efficient workflows, producing actionable insights, and delivering greater value to their clients.

Each session is grounded in practical, industry-relevant exercises, empowering consultants to create automated reports, perform advanced data analysis, and even develop custom AI-powered solutions for their clients' unique challenges. Our training is fully customized for the SME and consulting environment in Azerbaijan, ensuring all examples and demos are relevant and actionable for your day-to-day work.

We also provide foundational guidance in advanced Excel and Google Sheets usage, including techniques for automating routine calculations, creating dynamic dashboards, and building tools for financial analysis and business planning. Participants will leave with the ability to construct dashboards that visualize key business metrics, perform real-time scenario analysis, and facilitate smarter decision-making for their clients.

By the end of this program, each consultant will have not only mastered key AI tools but will also have developed tangible solutions to bring immediate value to their consulting practice, positioning them as digital leaders in Azerbaijan's growing business ecosystem.



Executive Summary

The rapid evolution of digital technologies, and particularly artificial intelligence, is re-shaping the future of business advisory services worldwide. For Azerbaijan's small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs), access to forward-thinking consulting is a crucial factor in driving competitiveness, innovation, and sustainable growth.

Recognizing this, the European Bank for Reconstruction and Development's Advice for Small Businesses (ASB) programme has made the professional development of local consultants a strategic priority, ensuring they are equipped to guide SMEs through the challenges and opportunities of digital transformation.

This proposal presents a two-day, in-person training designed specifically for ASB's dynamic group of local consultants in Azerbaijan. The training will blend foundational AI concepts with advanced, real-world applications, empowering participants with hands-on skills to:

- **Integrate AI tools into research, analysis, productivity, and the creation of client deliverables**
- **Automate routine consulting workflows and increase efficiency**
- **Develop a digital mindset to support SMEs in embracing new technologies**



Practical Demos

Through interactive workshops, practical demonstrations, and group-based projects, consultants will gain not just new knowledge, but actionable tools and confidence to lead digitalization efforts in their own practices and for their clients.



Presenter

Led by Aziz Aghayev, an international expert in AI, automation, and capacity-building with deep ties to Azerbaijan, this program is designed to inspire and upskill a new generation of SME consultants, delivering immediate impact for participants and lasting value for EBRD's mission in the region.



Background & Context

Azerbaijan's small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) are a vital driver of economic growth, employment, and innovation. Over the past decade, the country has made significant strides in building a supportive environment for entrepreneurship, with targeted reforms and growing access to finance, advisory services, and international markets. The European Bank for Reconstruction and Development (EBRD), through its Advice for Small Businesses (ASB) programme, has played a key role in this progress, helping to connect SMEs with qualified local consultants and raise the standard of advisory services across multiple sectors.

In recent years, the landscape for business advisory has rapidly evolved. Digitalization and artificial intelligence (AI) are transforming how consultants deliver value to clients: streamlining research and diagnostics, automating routine tasks, generating actionable insights, and enabling new, data-driven approaches to strategy and operations. For Azerbaijani consultants, proficiency with these emerging tools is becoming not only a competitive advantage, but an essential capability in supporting SME clients to modernize and thrive.

At the same time, the consulting profession in Azerbaijan is diverse and dynamic, ranging from experienced sector specialists to newer entrants, working in areas such as strategy, operations, quality management, sales, marketing, and project management. As businesses face heightened competition and look to digital solutions for productivity and growth, there is a growing need for consultants who can confidently integrate AI and digitalization into their work.

The EBRD ASB programme's commitment to continuous professional development for local consultants ensures that the Azerbaijani SME sector can benefit from global best practices and innovative solutions. By investing in advanced training in digitalization and AI, EBRD is strengthening both the consulting profession and the broader SME ecosystem, empowering local advisors to lead the way in digital transformation and to deliver greater impact for businesses and communities across the country.



Training Objectives & Outcomes

This two-day training program is designed to build the digital capacity of local consultants, equipping them with both foundational and advanced skills in the use of AI and digital tools within their consulting work. By the end of the workshop, participants will:

Gain Practical Skills in AI & Digitalization:

Learn how to leverage AI-driven tools for research, data analysis, diagnostics, and client communication, with step-by-step practice using widely available technologies.

Increase Consulting Efficiency and Impact:

Apply workflow automation and AI solutions to reduce time spent on repetitive tasks, improve the accuracy of deliverables, and free up resources for higher-value consulting activities.

Enhance Client Value and Service Offerings:

Develop the ability to introduce innovative digital tools and techniques to SME clients, helping businesses access new insights, streamline operations, and become more competitive.

Build a Digital Mindset:

Strengthen confidence in exploring new technologies and adopting a continuous learning approach, so consultants can remain at the forefront of market changes and future client needs.

Promote Collaboration and Knowledge Sharing:

Participate in interactive sessions and peer learning, fostering a community of practice among ASB consultants and supporting the long-term professionalization of the sector.

These outcomes directly support EBRD's mission to empower local advisors, accelerate SME digital transformation, and ensure that Azerbaijan's business support ecosystem remains resilient and forward-looking.





Proposed Training Program

1. Methodology & Approach

Hands-on, Demo-Heavy Approach: Training is highly practical and interactive, with real, industry-specific examples that reflect the SME consulting environment in Azerbaijan.

Dual Language Flexibility: Sessions can be delivered in either English or Azerbaijani, based on EBRD and participant preference.

Consulting-Focused Content: Every exercise is contextualized for consultants, focusing on business diagnostics, market research, financial modeling, client communications, and more.

Prompt Engineering & Custom AI Tool Development: Strong emphasis on crafting effective prompts, with volunteers and group activities to drive engagement. Participants learn how to build their own AI tools (e.g., custom GPTs and simple automations).

Morning-Afternoon Structure:

- Mornings: Trainer-led deep dives into prompt engineering, live demos, and mind-set/strategy for digital transformation.
- Afternoons: Application sessions tailored to attendee requests, working groups, real-life consulting challenges, laptop-based practice, and team presentations.

Pre-Training Survey: A short survey before the event will gather participants' priority topics and digital skill levels, ensuring the workshop is tailored for maximum relevance.

Peer Learning & Optional Clinic: Sessions include knowledge sharing and collaboration. An optional "clinic" allows for 1:1 Q&A, troubleshooting, and additional support.

Personal & Professional Empowerment: Brief focus on AI tools that consultants can use not just for client projects, but for personal growth and daily productivity.



Proposed Training Program

2. Day 1 Training Agenda

Morning:

Mindset Shift & AI in Consulting

Objective: Frame the opportunity of digital transformation in SME consulting; inspire openness to new tools and methods.

- Introduction to AI's relevance for consultants
- Mindset and adoption curve
- EBRD/SME examples

Prompt Engineering Fundamentals

Objective: Equip participants to craft high-quality prompts for real consulting scenarios.

- What makes an effective prompt?
- Live, practical demos: market research, report generation, business diagnostics, and communications
- Group and volunteer-driven exercises

Afternoon:

Hands-On Application: Attendee-Driven Consulting Challenges

Objective: Apply new skills to real-world problems, using actual consulting cases and SME data.

- Small group work and whole-room exercises
- Attendees work on live challenges, market analysis, diagnostics, financial modeling, or report creation
- Trainer circulates for coaching; teams share results



Proposed Training Program

3. Day 2 Training Agenda

Morning:

Advanced Applications: Deep Research & Custom AI Tools

Objective: Teach participants to design and build custom GPTs and AI workflows for their practice.

- Using ChatGPT agents and Gemini for research, automation, and analysis
- Demo: Uploading and analyzing regulatory or policy documents, generating insights for SMEs
- Building custom GPTs: structure, use cases, sharing
- Volunteers present consulting scenarios; live build of AI tools

Personal Productivity with AI

Objective: Highlight AI applications for consultants' personal and career development (e.g., calendar management, personal knowledge management, language tools).

Afternoon:

Capstone Working Session: Build Your Own AI Tool

Objective: Enable every participant or team to design, build, and present an AI-enabled tool tailored to their sector or client needs.

- Teams select a real consulting problem (e.g., regulatory FAQ bot, market analysis tool, workflow automation)
- Guided build and troubleshooting
- Group presentations: share solutions, receive feedback
- (Optional) "Clinic" session for 1:1 help or deeper Q&A

Throughout Both Days:

- Adapt to EBRD and participant feedback, with built-in flexibility.
- Every consultant leaves with new prompts, an AI tool, and a practical toolkit for continued innovation.



About the Trainer



Aziz Aghayev is an AI, automation, and digitalization specialist with 19 years of experience helping organizations and professionals bridge the gap between technology and real-world outcomes. He is the founder of Flowlyst, a leading provider of AI-driven training and consulting for public and private sector clients in the US, Azerbaijan, and internationally.

Aziz holds an MBA from the Isenberg School of Management at UMass Amherst and brings a uniquely diverse career background: he served as Chief Financial Officer (CFO) for over 14 years in the public education sector, where he led budgeting, compliance, and strategic automation projects. He then transitioned to software development and consulting, leading high-impact projects in AI implementation, workflow automation, and data analytics for schools, businesses, and

government agencies.

As a trainer, Aziz is recognized for his practical, demo-driven style and ability to make advanced concepts accessible. He specializes in capacity-building for mixed-experience groups, from seasoned professionals to digital newcomers, and is fluent in both English and Azerbaijani.

Credentials & Experience

- **Founder, Flowlyst:** Delivered AI, automation, and digital transformation workshops for dozens of organizations, tailoring programs for SME consultants, public sector leaders, and education professionals.
- **Former CFO (14+ years):** Led all financial, budgeting, compliance, and process improvement activities for a large public school networks.
- **Software Developer & Automation Specialist:** Extensive front-end and back-end engineering experience with major US firms (e.g., Comcast) and startups. Deep hands-on expertise in React, TypeScript, Python, and automation tools.
- **Trainer and Conference Speaker:** Featured at ASBO International, NJASBO, AASA, MASBO, the City of Lucas, Chicago Public Schools, Ebby Halliday Real Estate, and many urban and suburban districts; delivered programs for retail and small business clients.
- **International & Local Impact:** Led Ministry-level trainings, including the Ministry of Agriculture in Azerbaijan, where his sessions on prompt engineering, AI in sectoral practice, and custom GPT development were widely praised for their creativity and practical value.





Recognition & Client Feedback

Participants and partners describe Aziz's trainings as:

"Engaging, insightful, and filled with practical examples we can use immediately."

"AI can do a lot more than I expected... The creative juices started flowing and I learned how to prompt AI so it sounds more like me, authentic and useful, not robotic."

"Interactive training on the practical application of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in agriculture and personal development... Key topics included AI integration into daily workflows, automation, ethics, and data-driven decision-making."



Notable Engagements

- **Ministry of Agriculture, Azerbaijan** – Led interactive, hands-on AI workshops supporting digital transformation in the agricultural sector
- **ASBO, NJASBO, MASBO, AASA** – Multiple highly-rated sessions on AI, automation, and prompt engineering for public sector and education leaders
- **City of Lucas, Chicago Public Schools, and many more** – Training for municipal, urban, and suburban clients across industries including retail and small business

Aziz's work with Flowlyst has empowered hundreds of professionals to integrate AI into their work, enhance productivity, and lead digital change in their organizations. He brings both the strategic mindset of a CFO and the technical fluency of a modern software developer, ensuring each training is practical, relevant, and impactful.

* You can watch more testimonials on our YouTube and LinkedIn pages:

<https://www.youtube.com/@flowlyst>

<https://www.linkedin.com/company/flowlyst>

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/azizaghayev>



Relevant Engagements & Testimonials

Chicago Public Schools (CPS) – Transforming Operations with AI & Automation

Context:

Chicago Public Schools is one of the largest school systems in the US, with over 60,000 employees and a \$9.9 billion budget. Working closely with CPS, Aziz Aghayev led a series of high-impact automation projects, integrating AI and digital tools to address complex operational and financial challenges.

Key Solutions & Impact:

Grant Reporting Automation:

Implemented AI-driven automation for CPS's grant reporting process, saving the team approximately 60 hours per quarter.

Payroll Audit Automation:

Designed a payroll audit workflow that reduced manual processing from 3 hours to just 30 minutes per biweekly cycle, dramatically increasing efficiency and accuracy.

Error Reduction & Reporting Automation:

Developed tools for cross-checking and comparing payroll data, minimizing errors and making compliance easier.

Rapid Report Generation:

Enabled teams to create 60 different reports in under 15 minutes, a process that previously took up to 6 hours, allowing for faster decision-making and more time spent on strategic work.

Custom AI Dashboards:

Supported the deployment of a dashboard with 10+ custom GPTs, empowering employees to find information and follow procedures independently. This reduced the volume of phone calls to the business office and HR, increased employee self-sufficiency, and improved overall workflow transparency.

Outcome:

These automations led to significant time and cost savings, reduced human error, and empowered CPS employees to use data-driven decision-making in their day-to-day roles.





Fee Structure & Logistics

Professional Fee

Training Delivery: \$1,800 per day (USD)

Total for 2-Day Program: **\$3,600** (USD)

- Includes all advance preparation, workshop materials, and routine post-training support (as outlined).
- This fee is fixed for groups of up to 20 consultants.

Per Diem, Accommodation, Meals, and Local Transport

- To be reimbursed at EBRD's standard per diem rates for Baku, Azerbaijan.
- This covers accommodation, meals, and in-country transportation.
- All local expenses will be documented with receipts per EBRD policy.

International Travel

Flight (Dallas, TX to Baku, Azerbaijan):

- **Business Class (Preferred):** \$5,500–\$6,000 (Turkish Airlines, round trip as of July 2025).
- **Justification:** Business class travel will help ensure the trainer is well-rested and effective, minimizing jet lag and maximizing the quality of delivery for EBRD participants. This is strongly preferred due to the distance and quick transition required.

All airfare and travel cost estimates are current and may change at the time of booking. Final cost will be supported by receipts and coordinated with EBRD in advance.

Add-On Days

- **Additional days** (for 1:1 consulting, follow-up sessions, or custom support) may be added at **\$1,300** (USD) per day, subject to mutual agreement and availability.

Date & Availability

Available Window: **November 22 – December 12, 2025**

Trainings may be scheduled on any two consecutive days within this window. Due to high demand, early confirmation is **strongly requested** to secure these dates for EBRD



Fee Structure & Logistics

#	Description	Qty	Price	Total
1	Hands-On AI & Digitalization Training (day)	2	\$1,800	\$3,600
2	International Travel: Dallas – Baku (Estimated)	1	\$5,500	\$5,500
3	Per Diem & Local Costs EBRD standard rate (per day)	1	Per EBRD policy	
4	Accommodation/Meals		Included in per diem	
5	Local Transport		Included in per diem	
6	Additional Days (opt.) 1:1 consulting/follow-up, per day	1		\$1,300

Additional Notes

All estimates are based on current market rates and may change. Actual costs for travel and per diem will be reconciled with EBRD based on receipts and policy. Trainer fee includes all prep, materials, and routine post-training support.



Aziz Aghayev

Date: 07/28/2025

EBRD REPRESENTATIVE

Name: _____

Title: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____



Thank you for considering this proposal. We are excited about the possibility of partnering with your organization to harness the power of AI for enhancing your educational processes. We look forward to the opportunity to work together and contribute to your success. Please do not hesitate to reach out with any questions or for further discussion.

